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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, July 31, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=En_hnFZcwPw
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:13:12] that my name is john wadiska i'm the chair of the college partnership laboratory school standing committee and welcome to the second meeting second meeting in july of the standing committee mr chapman would you call the role for the members of the standing committee absolutely thank you miss wadiska mr bailey mr rotherham present mr hanson vice president or vice chair Dr. Moran? Present. And Ms. Wadiska? Present. We officially now are called to order. I have noted that I have approved the remote participation of Dr. Pam Moran and Mr. Bill Hanson under the

[00:13:51] board's bylaws section 2.2-3708 of the Code of Virginia. Such participation is allowed because both members principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location identified in the public notice we will begin today's meeting with a moment of silence followed by the pledge of

[00:14:11] allegiance so please at this time join me in a moment of silence if you please join me in the

[00:14:46] pledge of allegiance allegiance to the flag of the united states of america the republic which stands one nation under god indivisible with liberty and justice for all right the members of the standing committee were provided an agenda in advance of the meeting the original agenda included item b which has now been removed is there a motion to approve the amended agenda

[00:15:20] as presented to the standing committee so moved is there a second second uh the ayes those in favor please signify by saying aye aye chair votes aye as well motion is amended a motion is approved um we'll now take up for the approval of the minutes is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the standing committee all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye any opposed the same all right i the chair votes aye as well and the minutes for the last

[00:15:58] meeting are approved at this time we're going to move to the introduction of a new team member here at the videoe i believe that's my understanding that we are there don't be shy we're a friendly crew. Dr. Rayleigh. Well, good morning. Hope everyone is well today. It's my pleasure today to introduce you to a new staff member here at the Virginia Department of Education. I've had the pleasure of working with this individual for the past seven years and he's going to be a tremendous addition to our team here and in time will be leading the work related to lab schools.

[00:16:35] And so it's Dr. Andy Armstrong. Dr. Armstrong is a career educator who has served time in multiple jurisdictions as a teacher administrator assistant superintendent and even as an interim superintendent most recently in goochland county so it's a pleasure to welcome him to our team today he'll be working alongside this group as we continue to do the great work of lab schools and wanted to take a moment to introduce him to you today he is fresh from the job just about two hours and four minutes so uh wanted to give you a chance to meet him today so dr armstrong welcome

[00:17:10] thank you very much thank you all dr armstrong would you like to address the committee and welcome i mean first day on the job hour two and four minutes i mean i think this is the freshest staff member yes ma'am i i think i am i just got my badge about 20 minutes ago but it's great to be here i'm excited about the work that i'll be able to partner with this team on in the near future and moving on and appreciate the opportunity we are truly delighted to welcome you as well as to have your expertise in this entire division your your background is tremendous

[00:17:45] and you're going to be such a huge asset not only for the lab school work but also for innovation across the commonwealth so i really wholeheartedly welcome you to the video i appreciate that thank you very much all right at this time we would move to public comment on the agenda i understand that we have no public comment so i'm just going to keep moving right along to item a which is presentation from mr nicholas romanos the executive director of the international association of lab schools this is a presentation that i have been looking forward to for months um

[00:18:22] several months back when we started working on lab schools the preeminent organization to talk about the topic is the international association of lab schools and i reached out at that time to mr ramos who is the executive director of that organization he was gracious and helpful and giving of information in his time and i'm so delighted that we worked out our schedule so that he can be with us here today he has more than two decades he's been working on lab schools

[00:18:54] not only in the united states but internationally he is also a law school he's also teaching a seminar on legal aspects of education and he has been serving on their board as well since 2008.

[00:19:11] And so on behalf of the standing committee here in Virginia, Mr. Ramos, thank you so much for being with us virtually and sharing your wealth of insight and expertise with us as we look to review, approve, and help stand up high quality lab schools here in the Commonwealth of

[00:19:30] Virginia. Absolutely. Thank you very much for your invitation. I'm happy to be here with you.

[00:19:53] So I believe we have up on the screen your presentation and if you would like to begin walking us through um your information i think that would be a lovely time to do that absolutely so um who is or who are we in the international education of that school um so we provide mainly support to our member schools our member schools are that are associated or affiliated with the

[00:20:30] university or college but we also have a few uh a few schools that are independent and that their relationship with the university or college is different we concentrate or our members concentrate on uh teacher training curriculum development research professional development or professional growth and also innovation and what we do is that we are a voice for the improvement of learning through lab schools for all children and we also support our member schools

[00:21:10] through the process or whatever the process they choose in our next slide um so we don't have of our people and we do not think that we are an authority in defining boundaries based on who we are as an international organization so traditionally last two commitments have been to help prepare teachers but that has developed that has evolved uh and it has connected quite well

[00:21:45] with the improvement of instructional programs for children as well so usually last groups are affiliated with the college or universities for a particular purpose that they go beyond the scope of the traditional public or private institution i'll speak to that you know in a bit so over the years lessons have changed just to reflect just to reflect the diversity of students and the teaching profession as well as the world changing lab schools stay on top

[00:22:21] labs have often led the way in improving the science of teaching while making those improvements available to all so not only what happens at the lab school is innovation its research but we also have the goal of sharing it making it making those available to uh everyone in our next slide we go by tenants so we're not saying that every lab school has to have

[00:22:56] the five tenants what we're saying is that usually that's the fact characterized by either that they have a future preparation program where that they concentrate on research that teachers are allowed or given a little bit of space to develop the curriculum or that the school has the flexibility for teachers and staff to anyway and to try out strategies and techniques in education or

[00:23:31] that they concentrate on the continuous learning of their staff and teachers that they continue to grow and they focus on that now we have schools for example the last of the university of puerto rico we began as a teacher preparation program in the early 1900s but it developed into having a

[00:23:54] a research program, curriculum, and innovation, so classes are different and some of them are created just for the purpose of the university to conduct research, while including you see that every time it doesn't matter which one the last time to choose or which one they focus on, they're always connected to the level of learning.

[00:24:28] they're always connected to even a better quality of education to all the children. So regardless of what your tenant is, there is the purpose to have better teachers, therefore a better quality of education.

[00:24:47] So the next slide is basically what I have just stated. it it's not really necessary that's what they're different uh they could engage in all and we have the students that do engage in all but most of them have the particular interest so um but then our other set on improving future preparation program for the benefit all the way always for the benefit of children now again and i i'll repeat it from all all of our members and

[00:25:28] we know is that it is rest on the principle of improving teaching and learning stand by hand for all children our next slide uh so basically what does it take um usually when i get this question a lot uh how do you like to be in the lab school and um of course the first aspect is is the desire to improve education for both children uh if you if you're going

[00:26:05] without a path of creating a lab school that is the first ingredient that means then you'll ask yourself how do i do that while these are focused well usually if it's a strong connection with the university it's going to be research because we are going to be making decisions that are going to be uh for the improvement of of uh learning but they're going to be evidence-based of possible research is implemented to a uh a university that has a future training program usually with

[00:26:41] students with two teachers in a school in a lab school uh for that uh also if you're interested in developing curriculum like the last schools in different countries usually have a particular interest in developing the curriculum so that students they meet the state standards but they go beyond so they they usually have that freedom also if you're interested in teachers continuing

[00:27:17] to learn continuing to develop professionally to help benefiting children then you will go that way or if you want a school that has a lot of room to try out uh uh new uh strategies new techniques in education then you will go that way so another question that people ask is it something in public is it going to be private because of course uh you are going to have to take that into consideration what type of relationship will we have in the college or the university that's kind of a big

[00:27:53] question and it's going to depend on if you're going to have a school that's going to be based on research you need a strong connection to a college or university um college professors will train teachers in terms of research if you are going to uh or if you're going to have a last that's going to be based on research you're going to ask that teachers have higher education so that they're more familiar with research and our next slide i'm trying to compile time sorry uh so what

[00:28:31] does the successful lab school look like what does the successful lab school look like based on our experience that has international organizations when we go to the lab students are really happy uh uh um and then they they have the friends that belong to like this is my school and even when they leave even when they graduate they always come back and make reference to that school they also have a high college admission rate but not all kids are not all students go to

[00:29:06] college so that could also have students who do not go to college joining success for french church so so um you have that rate of success whether they choose to go to the workforce or whether they choose to go to college and students also comply with state testing scores even though like for example some schools are not mandated by the state but they still have their students as a way of measuring as a way of evaluating they still have their students take uh the state test

[00:29:45] and they usually most of their students usually 100 percent apply with those scores and you see another characteristic of the last school is that teachers have time to prepare they're not usually overloaded with a big size classes or five or six groups a day the organization of the last school is different which gives teachers time to prepare and to be more effective also administrators are in control and that's the responsibility but they also allow and they have some sort of room for

[00:30:22] teachers to innovate uh what are some of our international our next slide what are some of our international uh programs or international uh view of the university of toronto they have that schools that

are concentrated on inquiry victory base and this is innovation an area of innovation and they base their early childhood education throughout on inquiry uh but just all their school for girls so we would some people would say for a school for girls the lab school

[00:31:00] well like i said before if you want to create a lab school the first thing you need to have is a desire to improve education for all so this particular school is based on extensive experiences this is also innovation they make sure that the world will do some particular experiences and then they end up with a hundred percent college admission and a vertical force at the end when they graduate the american university in baghdad is also incubating but to the center

[00:31:39] because they are in some sort of a war zone they must have this particular care to students uh because of where they are uh second door school in thailand it's a demonstration school and a demonstration school is another name for a lab school but it brings in a little bit of definitions because they were born along with the university and they were there so that student features the even how it's done and they have a strong connection because demonstration schools

[00:32:16] want to be seen in that space between theory and practice and uh for example they have a college professor teaching some great english class at the last school but at the same time they have that same professor teaching methodology at the college of education and when she is teaching third college students uh here she said oh by the way tomorrow we're going to go to the lab you're going to see you're going to try it out you're going to teach this so demonstration

[00:32:51] schools usually have that room that close connection with the university and the law school the university of natal has a wonderful program their belief is that early childhood is the base is a strong base. Although they don't have programs that go beyond, they really think that if children are virtually taken care of from their early age, that's going to have an impact about their lives. The University of J.D. Italia in Finland is also a demonstration school. I was

[00:33:27] bored with the university and in Finland, all universities that have a teacher preparation programs must not allow school by law and it's true that when i was looking at the history of that school and and then students had the same genesis that you have in virginia in which they began with this opportunity for universities and the academic community and to develop ideas of that and later on i think developing to what we know that it is today and the university of

[00:34:01] is focused as a similar program uh that the university of the house which focuses on early childhood education last week at the university of puerto rico we are the research school we were born with the university in the late 1800s and 1900s and developed on to what we are today The Robin School of the Czech Republic is evidence-based, and usually it's similar to research, but at the same time every single education and every single decision that is made by the

[00:34:39] teachers and by the administration has to be evidence-based. University of Pittsburgh is based on research and teachers' preparation programs, starting at Mellon University, legal and mental research and that particular school not all last schools are run by the school of education or teaching program that that that was run by the school psychology and so it focuses on the mental

[00:35:13] process uh and as children and that's a very particular school in our organization and that's just run through what we are and what we do and just in a nutshell thank you so much for exciting thank you mr ramos i know we have questions um mr rotherham did you want to go first sir this is great go ahead

john no quite just um i mean no questions except for the what advice would you give us as we're thinking about um encouraging different type of lab school

[00:35:50] development here in the commonwealth of virginia and also as we're thinking about evaluating different types of lab schools great so first um like i said there there there's a potential has to have a clear idea as to how they want to improve teaching and learning what what their end result is i have a concern or i have this situation with children reading low grade level for example i want to focus on that and then you go well how are you going to do this are you going

[00:36:25] to have a connection with a university i'm going to be a case are you going to try out are you going to have an innovation or innovative approach in which you're going to try to have several strategies and you're going to try them and see what whether they work or they do not work um and and basically in terms of in terms of improving or in terms of considering the last is what they want and how they're going to do it and which tenet what tenets they're going to use

[00:36:58] to be able to achieve that and at the end of the day the resources that you give them for example should always be directed towards students and teachers for example um i plan to i plan to have all students reading at grade level by two years because i am going to have smaller groups or i'm going to this teacher or this teacher is going to be concentrated on uh um two groups or three groups

[00:37:36] like the last ones at the university teachers have only three groups of students and that gives them a lot of room a lot of time for them to focus and then move on and develop on to something else so So when you place resources, make sure that they are very close to school.

[00:38:00] Yes, equipment has infrastructure, but teachers and in terms of their level of work, it's going to be a little bit more expensive, but as we thought, it would be really close to students.

[00:38:18] You will see it. - Mr. Rotherham. - Thank you. Before I go, are there anyone on the phone? One, two. Pam, Bill, let me show you we didn't monopolize in the room.

[00:38:35] I would ask this question if I might. One of the areas that I'm really interested in is how lab schools can influence their peer groups that are not lab schools to adopt best practices, whether it could be something as you described with inquiry learning or it could be in regards to literacy work that's occurred in a particular lab school do you see good examples of that and how that

[00:39:07] mechanism gets triggered thank you so what i have seen is that in different countries lab schools have a time of the year in which they impact the public education for example many years ago the idea of manipulative using manipulatives in the classrooms on that were first tested at our laptop so we would have to discover this symposium uh this uh conference with uh public computers

[00:39:45] in which we would share information in which we would uh um sort of communicate or see each other as working teachers but we're also sharing information so we would invite them to that school and we would follow up the next year we also have a particular program in which the last was opened up and received students from public schools were elected because they were interested

[00:40:23] that elective was not offered at the public system. One of our teachers, 11th grade teacher was teaching biology and her students were very successful in the state mandated test, which the university was.

[00:40:41] We don't have to do it, but we still do it. And the way that education was happening at our lapses, we invited a group of students from our neighboring schools come in and be part of that biology class, for example. And then, how did they do in the testing afterwards, or what was the result of their visit?

[00:41:05] And that created a bond, and that created, and in Puerto Rico, our schools are very famous. Everyone knows the last school because of that connection to the community.

[00:41:20] so if you begin a conference or cycle of conferences with uh the school system sharing innovative ideas i think that creates a connection that other schools for example we impacted the private system for uh because in puerto rico we have another university that has six or seven last school and that all began without inviting us uh sort of having them come

[00:41:57] into the lab school and that's that's what started not any more public lab schools but yes some of the projects that we have the manipulative the teaching of science the way that art is taught we see it replicated in other public schools as well i don't know if i answered your question thank for any of our other uh mr hansen did you have any questions otherwise i'm going to go to mr

[00:42:30] rotherham back to mr rotherham all right mr rotherham oh there you go bill i don't okay very helpful thank you mr rama excuse me mr ramos has been terrific and actually one of my questions um dr moran took my other question is uh there's a lot of confusion we're hearing it here in the commonwealth there seems to be nationally just on like lab schools and charter schools and just with your expertise if you could just i mean you laid out the five tenets which i thought were very helpful and are very much the kinds of things we're trying to drive that here in virginia but if you could just talk about just in your in your view how do you see the how do you see the

[00:43:09] distinctions so there has been a lot of confusion not only in your state but really for the people because we do have services here as well and sometimes they want to label now the difference is that usually there is a purpose in the lab school there is an intent and i'm not saying that all uh other churches do not want uh or their designers not for all children to learn what i'm saying is that there is an intention

[00:43:49] there is a conscious uh will to improve and there is there is a direction that i'm going so if i go to the last school and i usually begin talking i already know whether they do research or they're doing future preparation program what is your focus because it's it's evident charter schools uh uh do not have that particular uh direction um but they may you may see from charter schools that are geared towards STEM education or that they have other

[00:44:27] particular areas that they want to think of them can have STEM programs but the end result is the improvement of teaching home learning it's the improvement of learning by children whether it being their staff whether it's being through other programs but i am one of the tennis i am taking a step-by-step approach to have the improvement of learning for all children also

[00:45:01] lapses have a stronger connection to university because because sometimes usually elastas want to move forward and it's usually evidence-based it's not just i'm not saying i see as a picture of myself for 20 years my intuition is all there but not saying that we're not going to use intuition but mainly it's evidence-based uh and last things are also like that and that is that's a particular

[00:45:40] characteristic of a lab school that it's not just a school open to learning it's a school that consciously works every day to better education for all children through research the collection teachers

come from the university or our teachers go to the university um i we receive to the teachers from the university uh at all levels sometimes when they start and then they have

[00:46:14] several first year students coming in second year students come in several times and then for the student teachers a year that they spend at the last school that's another characteristic of the last school as well so the connections to the university the particular connection to student learning is evident so and officially not that like a fellow person would listen or read yours there's going to be some confusion but once you go in and start asking a few questions you know

[00:46:49] you'll see that uh this is just because of those conscious or particularly directed towards the bettering of education for our children thank you mr ramos this has been invaluable um i probably have at least 70 questions but in the interest of time today i'll just ask the one for now the the objective of the lab committee is to not only create a process to consider applications

[00:47:24] for lab schools here in the commonwealth but we really have to kind of evaluate those applications ultimately rendering a yay or a nay to the state board of education is your thinking about lab schools what would you advise us should be gating criteria to evaluate applications for quality to ensure just the tenants that you've provided are excellent but how would you weigh what would be the criteria that you would use and how might you

[00:48:02] approach this challenge okay so i i would want to separate uh applications by by that particular interest of taking care of learning and the possibility of that happening for example if i see an application that has a a a strong definition of a connection to a university

[00:48:42] but does not have that that particular school or where are the students where is the school oh um and that is not really that is an abstract idea then i would do the university it's okay but where are the children or which area are you are you going to impact with your with your math school is it an existing school is it an exclusive public school or is it going to be a school that

[00:49:16] is going to be created or that university is going to create a lab school so a strong application would be clear on that i am a teacher preparation program and these are the students that i plan to impact with my school it's clear because it's concrete those are the students and i'm going to begin with a teacher preparation program i am going to send my see my uh my teachers to that

[00:49:51] law school and then i am going to use that to better education for children working with children these are the students that i'm that i'm going to be targeted it's not some say a last drive that um it's clear you have a clear program and if you if they begin with the future preparation program always say oh always ask how is education going to be better because it seems to me that you're going to be successful for the benefit of the university has led you to provide an area for

[00:50:30] the university to take their students to become teachers yes but how is that going to be how is example better education for children better education for their children and of course that's going to be connected to the main uh philosophy of education or to the main idea that they presented to you at the beginning and and you have to see that happening through the uh teacher preparation program and if you see a program that is going to be uh geared towards

[00:51:06] teacher preparation look at the preparation of the teachers who are are they if they're going to be using if they're going to be having teachers new teachers that just got out of college the teacher

preparation program put a big question about because if the university is going to use students develop teachers these uh master teachers have to have graduate graduate education and have

[00:51:41] experience because that is how they're going to that is going to be the balance between some people that call student teaching uh programs because they say oh i don't know why my my child to be taught by a student teacher all year well if you have a really cooperative teacher you have a master teachers we're going to balance that out and make sure that the end result is that there's better education for children however that's done um then if you have a uh an application

[00:52:19] that represents that particular interest make sure that the teachers are strong and that um that the university has that balance and that you require them to give you a clear idea of what is how is education going to be better for children and i could sit here and tell you several examples but i know you're kind of limited uh you could also do it with research if they tell you that they're going to be doing research you want those teachers to have a connection with a university

[00:52:55] no law school should be no law school can stand uh on a research program without the help without the connection to a university and to the college professors um innovation that's where you uh we'll have to look at the administration if they're going to have room for innovation a strong administration that will keep the most uh areas of innovation uh uh so that the school can still

[00:53:30] combine yes they're doing similar differences and especially development in the schools that you receive with an idea of a professional development you receive a new lab school with it could have all teachers fresh out of college because that that lab is going to improve teaching it's going to improve learning because they're going to implement a teacher professional development program for their staff and that's the beginning that's the first stage if they give you an application for that ask them after that first year what's next after those

[00:54:09] teachers are trained after that professional what's next how are you going to keep learning happening at all levels of students and the teachers that was excellent i i am incredibly appreciative for your insight i think it really helps frame um not you know one of the things we've really is to ensure that these applications are complete and compliant and what you're really

[00:54:44] answering and helping us wrestle to the ground is ascertaining quality which is ultimately what we want is high quality durable lab school so that was excellent i suspect we will have you back in the future yes without question um we will be pinging your expertise on future items but i thank you for the beginning of a conversation with this committee on behalf of the commonwealth so thank you very much absolutely i'll stay available to walk with you this time we're really thrilled that everyone is hopefully last week every time a last book opens we're going to be there to support

[00:55:24] the process and to guide you through it so i'm available please let me know i am willing to help thank you so much for inviting me we're honored to be part of this process thank you thank you all right at this time we are going to move to item b which is a closed session for legal advice the standing committee is going to be hearing will be briefed on a number of items from the office of the attorney general just for the benefit of our guests what is going to happen next is that we're going to go through a series to make a motion to go into closed session then anyone that is not privy to that closed session is unfortunately going to have to leave

[00:56:03] the room when we conclude our closed session staff will notify you and you'll be allowed to re-enter the room so i apologize for the inconvenience of temporarily relocating you but we will have to relocate our guests including staff that are not part of this session so at this time i will entertain a motion to enter closed session great i move that the college partnership laboratory school standing committee can be closed for the following purposes consultation with legal counsel employed by or retained by a public body regarding specific legal matters

[00:56:38] requiring the provision of legal advice by such counsel pursuant to section 2.2-3711 of the code of virginia and the legal counsel to standing committee and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of the matter will participate in the closed meeting is there a second second all those in favor please signify by saying aye the chair votes aye as well and we

[00:57:05] are now in closed session meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above in accordance

[01:10:10] with the freedom of information act section 2.23712 the code of virginia requires that the state of committee certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one uh only public business matters lawfully exempt from the open public media requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes that there was a departure from these requirements shall uh so stay prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the

[01:10:47] departure will be recorded in this uh in the minutes now i think we move to a vote certification correct correct i'll call the members names please uh certify by voting aye or nay mr bailey

[01:11:03] aye mr hansen it looks like he's waiting to join in the lobby thanks kevin proceed dr moran

[01:11:30] aye mr rotherham aye mr hansen we were voting on the uh or certifying the closed meeting uh iron or nay all right thank you and miss wadiska sorry i had to change devices i've been to the airport thank you as well thank you thank you staff for your assistance at this time we'll move

[01:12:06] to item c which is first review of the college partnership lab school application from james madison university please join us at the podium introduce your team and let us know who is with us today good afternoon afternoon i'm still morning my name is mark lesbronson professor of education and dean of the college of education at james madison university uh dr larry shiflett the superintendent of rockingham county public schools and brian zugelder the associate dean of

[01:12:40] for college of education along with caitlin reed our legislative liaison are here today uh jeez i tell you mr ortez set the table for us i'm pretty excited the five tenancy talked about teacher prep programs research curriculum innovation and professional growth deeply embedded in the application uh just for uh sort of a backdrop on this is if you remember december 14th of last year we met with the standing committee we actually submitted our application September of 2022. And over the last year, we've worked diligently with teams from the BDOE and

[01:13:17] other groups to prepare for today. And I want to especially thank Dr. Raleigh for all his, really his critical leadership to get us to this point. So we're really looking forward to presenting what we have, and we're looking forward to moving forward. So with that, I'm going to turn that over to both Dr. Zugelder

and Dr. Shiflett, and then I'll be available for questions also, but thank you so much for your time again. Good morning. I'm Brian Zugelder, Associate Dean for Academic Affairs and

[01:13:53] Partnerships in the College of Education at JMU. Excited to be here. The presentation that you're about to hear is a high-level overview of the in-depth application that you have seen and have provided feedback on over these last few months. Aligned with the speaker who presented on the tenets of lab schools and components of effective lab schools, we feel that our vision and mission is nicely aligned to those. You can see that our desire is to be an innovation hub where we are

[01:14:32] solely focused on career exploration and workforce development, where we are leveraging the strengths of james madison university not just in the college of education but university-wide and also blue ridge community college one of the things that we want to do is reimagine what teaching and learning looks like in high schools and so we're doing that with rockingham county public schools and we're very excited to have the superintendent and the support of his board So the pre-professional career pathways that you'll see in the application are inclusive

[01:15:09] of our planning discussions that we've had with our colleagues across campus and with Blue Ridge Community College. You can see education is at the forefront. What better time to focus on education when there is a teacher shortage, giving people opportunities to learn about those pre-professional pathways in education health professions social services government and public relations on the right side of that screen you'll see the strengths of what blue ridge community college has to offer through aviation maintenance automotive technology business management and i.t and so together we're

[01:15:44] leveraging the strengths of both those organizations and rockingham county public schools and so our intention is to have a lab school in each of our four high schools east rockingham Broadway, Spotswood, and Turner-Ashby. We would begin in year one at East Rockingham and Broadway.

[01:16:05] And we want to be very intentional because each of these four high schools are distinct, right? They're Gobblers, they're Eagles, or Trailblazers, what have you. They're mascots. But at the same time, we want to make sure that these lab schools, that we have a branding so that no matter if a student is at Broadway or East Rock or Spotswood, if he or she is in the lab school, there's a sense of what that looks like what it feels like what is the branding that comes with that so we want to be very intentional about that in the planning process uh so that someone visiting

[01:16:40] any one of the lab schools right even if they would visit maybe a the model at jmu or blue ridge community college they would have a sense of this is what the lab school looks like there here's the sense that they could you know the sense of purpose and mission that what we're trying to accomplish. In terms of student population, as I mentioned earlier we would start at East Rockingham and Broadway High School 24-25 school year hopefully with 50 students in that rising would be the freshman class of that year and then as we get into the following school

[01:17:15] year 25-26 we would then add and expand to Spotswood and Turner Ashby with their freshman class as we also expanded into the sophomore class at East Rockingham and Broadway so you see it growing the numbers moving up as we go year to year and then in 26-27 we would then expand it with our sophomore class at Spotswood and Turner-Ashby and so and and then as the students get into that junior year for those kids in 26-27 at East Rock and Broadway they will have some

[01:17:53] options, right? Some of them may choose just to go back to more traditional high school experience. Some may want to go into our technical school, Mass Newton Technical Center, where they can explore some trades and career paths, looking at some dual enrollment with Blue Ridge Community College or JMU. So there will be options. And so the number may decrease with that class going from 50 freshman year 50 sophomore year maybe not as many that junior year right and we continue to grow and expand uh each year until we get to anticipated population of 600 students

[01:18:32] this would be what just a sample schedule for um that very first year 24 25 rockingham county operates our high schools operate on an odd even schedule so we have blocks of time and students have four classes on an odd day and four classes on an even day and we would dedicate the first two blocks both odd and even day to the lab school and really trying to be flexible with the time right not not so much regulated by the bells other than when the time comes for them to transition to the normal high school and then in the afternoon on an odd

[01:19:10] day they would have a chance an opportunity for a cte elective and then a math elective and then on an even day in the afternoon there would be an opportunity for resource or a fine arts elective and then world language at the last part of the day so there's still opportunities for students to experience a traditional high school in terms of earning their credits for either an advanced diploma or standard diploma the nature of the coursework is that of interdisciplinary So we think about that very first group coming in looking at my place in this world.

[01:19:48] So taking English 9, Environmental Science, World Geography and Health and PE 9. All of our freshmen take those courses and they're also in Rockingham they're not leveled. And so this gives us an opportunity to very broad brush all students could then apply and we wouldn't have to, you know, exclude any group of students.

[01:20:12] and using a project-based approach students would then look at the the environmental interactions between humans and the world and how they impact globally but also even in their own daily life what does that look like and so also enhancing the 5c so there'll be content knowledge but also working on those skills of communication critical thinking collaboration creativity and citizenship and then as students move into their junior senior year we want to be very intentional

[01:20:50] about building opportunities for internships and externships and community service that's part of this career exploration component trying to to build a workforce for our community as kids are thinking about career options and opportunities what does that look like for them and then giving them a chance to experience it in their juniors and senior years of high school before they may either one go into the workforce or to go into higher education or trade schools.

[01:21:24] So Dr. Shifflett mentioned the locations for the lab school at the four high schools and we want to really think about what that will look like from innovative learning spaces. So in addition to those spaces at the high school we plan to provide space at both jmu's memorial hall used to be harrisonburg high school but it is now the college of education at jmu so the space is already uniquely fit for inviting high school students into the building as well as at blue

[01:22:03] ridge community college and in the startup funds that you see in the application we have some plans for renovating some spaces and also including some innovative technology, furniture, those kinds of things are in our plans for that. One of the things that we also envision is that if there is a pre-service class at JMU, maybe it's an education methods class, that we could

[01:22:37] connect via satellite or whatever you will at say east rock high school to be able to see what's happening in the classroom there and also where east rock students can communicate with students at broadway high school via those innovative learning spaces a lot of the essence of what you saw as dr shifflett mentioned the choices that students have this is about student voice and choice even in the curriculum and looking at what the problems are in the community and helping to

[01:23:12] shape what the curriculum will be having student voice parent voice and and student choices in that this is very difficult to see on a slide but in the application you'll see the organizational chart the governance of the lab school where there is a board for the lab school and the heads of each organization will have a shared model in reporting to that board and then the executive director of the lab school will report to the dean of the college of education at jmu there are three

[01:23:46] important committees that report to that executive director where it's about input stakeholder voice it includes parents experts and the community in that and then of course all of the teachers the the JMU faculty who will be involved in the lab school, the industry experts, the paraprofessionals, and the Blue Ridge Community College faculty will all report to the executive director for that part of the lab school.

[01:24:20] As you can see, the staffing model builds with time because as we increase with students, we increase with staff. You'll see that the ratio of staff to students is lower than the recommendation in the standards of quality.

[01:24:36] In year one, that ratio is about one to 13, but it never really goes higher than one to 16 as far as the teachers of record and the students, plus all of the additional supports in the school lower that ratio even further. As we get to year three, we know that the student population will expand, so we plan to include an assistant director, kind of like an assistant principal, And that model, which you'll find in the application details on that.

[01:25:07] For professional development and support, which is another tenant that we enjoyed hearing about this morning from the presenter is built into the lab school model is a coaching framework that we've developed.

[01:25:22] We actually started developing this in the 2019-20 year under the auspices of the Virginia Department of Education, where we have unpacked the uniform guidelines of the performance standards for teachers and have created a series of professional practice progressions.

[01:25:41] And so the training that everybody in the lab school will get is aligned with how those teaching standards are unpacked by looking at evidence in the classroom and how teachers can grow no matter where they are, whether they're early career, whether they're in their 10th year of teaching, this is a framework of support for professional learning.

[01:26:03] So you'll see that built into the budget and how we are providing that support for the teachers. In addition to that, we also have the Virginia principal support program, which is very similar in nature that will provide support for all of the administrators in Rockingham County and those who are interacting with the lab school from JMU and Blue Ridge to be a part of.

[01:26:29] so we can we can both talk about the finance model um you'll see that the five years of of financial plans built into the uh lab school model is based on a shared cost where um you know jmu has

invested already um i think you may have seen jmu has invested about 1.7 million dollars and funding already for the lab school rockingham county as well in personnel and spaces and planning

[01:27:03] in human capital all of that you will will see in there the model that we built for funding the lab school is a tuition model and we did put that in the lab school at the advice of the VDOE where the funding would function similar to that of a regional governor's school.

[01:27:26] So in year one the tuition rate is a little bit higher to get things up and running but then in year two it scaffolds down to a lower cost where it's about six thousand dollars per student and if you look at the ADM for Rockingham County Public Schools it's about 50 percent of Rockingham's ADM.

[01:27:46] after the lab school funding dissipates we plan on sustaining that model through that tuition support but also our development team at jmu as well as leveraging the strengths of a university where we are always looking at external funding you may or may not know this about the college of education at jmu we are the highest earner of external funding than any other college within jmu And so we have a good track record of getting grants.

[01:28:20] That's another thing that can help sustain our work in the long run. So 23-24 is our startup year. And so you'll see this referred to in the application as year zero, where we will really be hitting the ground, looking at how we gather those teams, hire the executive director, recruit students.

[01:28:45] there's already a lot of buzz in rockingham county public schools about this with stakeholders in the community with the principals of the schools the teachers of the schools and so we are ready to get started on that work where we will be planning for an opening of fall of 2024 finished so abruptly i wasn't quite ready for it just enjoying listening to your presentation all right so i'm

[01:29:19] So I'm going to go to our committee members in the room first, then we'll go to those on remote and I'll wrap up with questions as well. So, Sir Rotherham. Excuse me, I've got a couple, but let me start with a big one that staff flagged and I was a little unclear on, and the Attorney General's representative is here too if we have questions on this.

[01:29:45] It seems like there's some places where we're requesting waivers on SOLs, and I wanted to hear what that looks like. our authority to do that is extremely limited. And in many cases, absolutely non-existent. And so I wanna make sure we're clear on that.

[01:30:01] But second, how you all are envisioning that and what is even the instructional philosophy behind why you would be doing that? - Yeah, so Dr. Shiflett can clarify this in particular, but we did see that feedback. Of course, when the application asked for, would you be applying for waivers?

[01:30:20] Of course we would, but within compliance. So we did see that feedback. And we do know that there are two subject areas that Rockingham is already working on that is also in compliance. So perhaps maybe you can clarify that.

[01:30:37] Yeah, so currently, Rockingham County has been leveraging the performance assessments for writing, and we've been doing that over a number of years, the body of evidence from the freshman, sophomore, and junior year. And this year, we're going to embark on using the performance assessment for world geography, these are tasks created by the Department of Education, and this will be our first year doing that so.

[01:31:00] Looking to the future, but the lab school this lends itself beautifully to this idea of performance based learning to use these performance tasks to measure these so I see no need for a waiver for those those assessments. Okay, and then you all also talk about portfolios and sorry we jumped right into it, this is it's an exciting proposal and we say I should have like got the like we've seen you all before I think this is an interesting idea.

[01:31:24] Um, uh, so I, I, I shouldn't let that go without saying, although it should go without saying, um, I say, so you, the portfolios talk about that. And in particular talk about, you know, you all are professionals, you know, there's a problem with sometimes portfolios can become a little bit of a race to the bottom and you bring in community members, but no one wants to be the community member who comes in and says, Hey, your work's not up to snuff to some kid that they don't even know.

[01:31:50] like you know the department as you said has tools to try to ensure rigor there like as you all are thinking about portfolios how are you going to ensure that we actually maintain a high bar of rigor um uh around that right and so going back to what mr ortiz said talking about the enhancement of certain things right so here's a perfect example so you still have the traditional types of assessments now when you're given student choice right it's a portfolio especially e-portfolio is a purposeful collection of student work so over the course of their time students are making the selection no different than if you were doing a portfolio to show for your next job performance

[01:32:27] what are some of the things that you do it doesn't mean that that is a pass fail from that standpoint it is a student-led so that's part of the collection of work so over a two or three year period i'll think about it from a research standpoint how that can be used to help inform and be data directed to inform the way we do things as far as pedagogy instruction from a student standpoint career choice i noticed over the last two years with self-reflection why i like certain things geez i really like airplanes i want to work with aviation dynamics but i'm really excited about the scientific part my reflections back it up i want to you know i'm

[01:33:05] going to go to blue ridge community college so it's actually a toolbox for the students as they move forward it's not necessarily for public display that a group would come in and evaluate whether thumbs up or thumbs down that portfolio is worth the attention we have traditional assessments and non-traditional assessments okay built by professionals for that purpose so not to put words in your mouth what i'm hearing is you're going to use these for a formative various form various formative purposes you're not anticipating them to be a summative form of

[01:33:34] accountability. Can you talk a little bit more about the career exploration and the career pathways? I know there's exposure to different types of careers, but how are you helping students with making sense of the different pathways they have available to them after they complete the program? So the instructional team, we see that unfold in several different ways.

[01:34:02] while the teachers of record will be one critical part of this depending on what the problem is that is addressed or intending to address in the community the industry experts from that particular area like for example if there is a clean water issue bringing in somebody from the community who is an industry expert in that who can help be a part of that instructional team as an additional support to that for the career exploration pieces um in particular at blue ridge

[01:34:38] and at jmu the faculty who are involved in this work are faculty in those particular areas so there might be somebody from teacher ed who's identified as that faculty expert and also building capacity

within the teachers who are um you know designing and and providing the teaching and learning for the students, so that there's kind of like this content expert as a part of that team. Another example would be nursing. A nursing faculty member would be a part of that.

[01:35:08] We do envision that students would have the opportunity to enroll in pre-service courses at JMU where they would get some college credit, also while not stepping into the territory of dual enrollment with the community college, but complementing that as they move forward.

[01:35:25] And in some ways to be touched often by many. So you think of it's almost a team of folks, depending on that team changes. There's a core team that would be the educational piece of that. But then there's a group of folks, depending on what the problem is. And when we say problem, we want students and parents and stakeholders say, here's something in our community that we all share, that we'd like to work on.

[01:35:49] And that becomes sort of the centerpiece for the interdisciplinary curriculum. And that's where it's outlined specifically the instructions of how the SOLs are incorporated into that type of curriculum. - Great, and then some of the CTE or the information technology, automotive technology, does any of that ladder up into another credential or certification, or is it just getting exposure to those areas?

[01:36:16] - And again, that would be, if you want to add something to that, Larry, but then. - Yes, it could for the students in their junior senior year who wanted to get those credentials they certainly could take a path right really thinking about how many ways can we kind of exposures we can provide to students their freshman and sophomore years about the different careers there as we're working through various projects and then that junior senior year there are opportunities to make a choice about which direction they'd like to go they could definitely look for credentials and also our technical center a mass nun technical center would be a place that students could go to get credentials as well right

[01:36:53] thank you dr moran i i want to follow up on that one of the the pieces that i'm really interested in is how you will document perhaps at the beginning of that junior year if not earlier what pathway students see themselves as seeking as they transition from high school into adulthood so that there may be some kids that see themselves as going towards community college towards four-year towards workforce credentials or even into the military um to be able to you

[01:37:31] know seek some development in that area which is very uh not just lucrative but also um provides kids with lots of opportunities for education beyond high school so i'm i'm interested in how is it that we might be able to document where kids see themselves heading in terms of those pathways And then if they change that, I would really be interested in why students change what their direction may be, because I think it could offer some good research and insight into the idea that

[01:38:06] everybody that's out there is talking today about that college is not necessarily the end game for all kids coming out of high school. I'd love to be able to look at this as a little bit of a research study around that. Right. That's great. And that's why we have it's interdisciplinary because we do have a number of folks from both uh the university as far as the different sort of like you know everything guidance counselors advising my just to give you an example my own journey 17 years old my parents signed me off to the military i spent seven years in the military came out

[01:38:42] was a police officer i worked in the adolescent psychiatric hospital went through college middle school teacher i worked at a university now i'm a dean now i'm sitting here so the pathway at 17 was not the same pathway that i imagine most children will take the big thing is how do we capture especially in middle school and the neat part about this concept working with rockingham county they have such a structure set up in their middle schools that that's where we're already getting information from students so baseline information that you're talking about doctor is it's there we have that there and then we begin to track the pathway as we follow it

[01:39:18] through because again again going back to that e-portfolio that e-portfolio really plays a lot of self-reflection as students because they'll meet with people on an ongoing basis in their parents which is another key so by the time they're probably midway through their sophomore year they're saying you know what i really think that this mass not in tech may be the best route for me would it be the best route we'll follow those students because the cool part about this no matter where they go their junior and senior year they still will work together on community based problems so that's not going away we're keeping the cohorts together which is truly an

[01:39:55] exciting part of this lab school so we'll be able to keep that longitudinal data and we'll have that for both short-term baseline data but then how again because we go through the irb how students over a period of time follow that pathway but those are two research questions that we will be

[01:40:11] Thank you, Dr. Moran. Mr. Hanson? Okay. Well, first, I want to thank you again for being here and for your patience throughout the process. I know that you have been, I believe, the very first application in the Commonwealth, and we have been endeavoring to stand up a process, and I know that you've gone through a couple iterations, and so it isn't been the most clean or quick process, but really

[01:40:49] The wonderful things are rarely ever that. So I want to kind of acknowledge in your application, yeah, so first, thank you for your patience and your professionalism throughout the process. The staff have indicated you've been consummate professionals, and I know it's hard to wait.

[01:41:06] The second is I want to thank you for the letters of support of which are included in your packet. Not only do you have a letter from your Board of Regents, obviously the superintendent being here but your school board your community blue ridge county uh blue ridge excuse me community college and so you've really done your due diligence to engage the entire community and multiple decision makers at various levels and we we want to see that because as we heard from mr ramos that's so critical in both the outreach for the program the engagement and it is something

[01:41:41] that we look at to ensure and help prompt for sustainability so it's really important that you took the time to do those letters and please let the individuals who wrote the letters know how much we did appreciate them i'm going to have some detailed questions just because i want to think through this with you and you've had some time to really sit with the application this is our first time to really sit with it in this current format with you you probably heard that the real focus of these lab schools has got to be on the teaching you know so who are the teachers how are they being prepared and then what's going on in the classroom you know the learning part

[01:42:19] and so i'm going to go kind of in the order of your application and the questions that video we has raised as areas where maybe more information was required so just for the for the benefit of the committee and the the public one of the things we have the staff do is they review an application is to ensure that it is complete and compliant the next stage when it comes to the lab school is really to start to

dig into these questions also of quality and so even if an item might be complete or compliant um you you come to before the lab committee might get judged up a little

[01:42:54] might fancy you up a little bit to to help focus in and refine around that area of teaching and learning so that's kind of the the the focus of the the line of questions i'm going to have the first is i want to acknowledge also and this we're going to go into the teaching bucket for a moment you're one of the biggest producers of teachers in the commonwealth of virginia and i think you might be number one or number two depending on number two i know you're going to try to buck number one but like but but you're producing how many teachers per year well over 300. exactly which is phenomenal and i want you to talk more granularly about how you are going to

[01:43:35] utilize that expertise that you have to select the teachers for this lab school, do the professional development for those teachers that are in the lab school, give them time, how you're going to be including your students in, you know, as pre-licensure activities, the paraprofessionals, and then as you're learning kind of elements around teaching professional development how you're going to be applying it to jmu and and i want to say just kind

[01:44:12] of at the front is i want to really unpack this what is going on with the teachers because you're one of the best and the biggest you're going to have an opportunity to learn from this apply from it utilize that resource that you have and push it in in a way that potentially some of our other applicants won't you have depth and you have bodies in a way that no one else will and when And when I read your application, I wanted so much more in that area, because I know that your school of education has so much more.

[01:44:43] I know that you're doing, you know, you mentioned one of them, the, how do you refer, it's V-A-N-N-S. V-A-N-T-S-P, Virginia New Teacher Support Program. Is there an acronym that, like, is there a way that people say that you just go through the letters?

[01:45:00] We say V-A-N-T-S-P. Okay, okay, all right. I was trying to figure out the letters. And you also have, like, the New Teacher Support Program, I mean, you have so many amazing programs more granularly talk to us what's going on with the teachers at the lab schools and how are you using students at jmu who are going through your school of education through these labs so one of the benefits um we'll start with the va ntsp one of the benefits of this university based model for coaching is that we learn as a teacher education entity what works best in

[01:45:37] teacher development and so the essence of that program is focused focused on coaching so how do we help coaches be better so that they can help teachers be better so we have partnership networks across the commonwealth where we're already working on this in the lab school in particular the teachers no matter where they are they might be in year zero they might be in year 20. we can help the teachers have an individualized approach to what they need to work on and it's all grounded in the teaching standards of virginia so if student engagement is something that the teacher

[01:46:17] would need to work on the coaching framework in that is is quite granular in fact we have a about an 84 page document that is like a technical assistance document that unpacks all of these things that we develop that we call the professional practice progressions where we could go and watch a teacher for a snapshot of a lesson or we could watch an entire lesson or we could look at a lesson plan or we could look at student work and we can through coaching help that

[01:46:50] teacher understand where they fall in this continuum of progressions from is this action more like an early career teacher or is this action more like a highly effective teacher? And if it's maybe somewhere in the middle, using that coaching conversation and evidence from what we're seeing, we can help you move from here to here.

[01:47:13] So it's more about the actual practice of planning, instruction, and assessment, while also incorporating all the social emotional pieces that come from coaching. the essence of what the program will do. It is about individualizing what someone needs through establishing goals where the coach meets with the teacher to determine what that teacher needs. It's not evaluative, but it's actually a safe space for teachers to grow and learn and take risks and learn from their mistakes. The training that the coaches get is really helping

[01:47:52] to shape um i would call it fidelity of implementation in coaching where um we have coaching conversations on what does this look like if we're focused on questioning or if we're focused on um you know using uh teacher feedback how does a student use teacher feedback and unpacking that so that's the kind of granular professional development that will happen and it's really a nice um a nice uh piece of the puzzle for the lab school because it doesn't

[01:48:26] really matter what the teaching and learning of the lab school shapes up to be because it's really about the teaching standards so whether you're teaching pre-k or special ed or high school physics we're all focused on the same standards and how do i help you where you are unpack those and it's uh and part of that coaching model is uh real-time coaching digital recordings so that feeds back to our pathways of pre-service teachers that they'll be able to see within the lab setting

[01:49:00] best practices and then within their pre-service classes that they'll be able to deconstruct those and look through those analyze those tapes with different areas again in planning instruction and assessment which are very key and then additionally depending on where the students are in their program which programs they're in whether it be special education or secondary programs they'll have different opportunities to go to the four different sites for intentional practicums that are aligned with their courses and that's only just that's for teacher education but the same

[01:49:35] thing can be said for social work you know uh for nursing and we have the other our other partners on campus will be doing the same thing working with the master level teachers that will be selected rockingham county again that team approach students will be able to see that team working on the interdisciplinary curriculum and actually be part of it also on different occasions uh be able to uh to work and see how it's done at that highest level a teacher understands pedagogy they may understand some content you're bringing somebody from the business world in a particular area all of a sudden that content is enhances a learning experience not only for one of the

[01:50:15] superintendent's teachers but at each level when you bring a professor in depending on what the professor is it's for biology or environmental science again that enhancement of what's taking place in the process so it's there's a linear process how to create the curriculum and then how to implement it then how to assess it but it's really a sort of a circular process on the different touch points of learning growth do you mind going to the slide for a moment i just want to drill into this make sure that i understand on your staffing um so on let's say let's look at

[01:50:53] year one for a moment of these individuals which ones are the coaches is it the executive director who who kind of wears that coach hat so i i love what you just described who is the person and

responsible for that So the coaches are actua that. Um, so the coaches with Rockingham County. S who enrolls in the VA NTS gets a coach. And so we w to identify who are the c

[01:51:31] based on what the teache on their content, experti of experience. So for exa are working with these pe one, for example, some of in the building at East R might be at Turner Ashby be at the division level already are instructional on this is the group of t need and how am I going t with a coach that makes s contribution because that' we have going on as a prin

[01:52:09] in the CTA which is a summer program for teachers that is a professional growth model so the lab school is not designed for that one particular model as the primary function of that that initiative that is an in-kind contribution like the other initiatives that we're doing at the college to support the lab school so some of the additional professional learning I think I just heard two answers though there I heard one saying it was JMU who's providing it that's what you just it's an income contribution as far as it and we're integrated with with the lab schools it's like one

[01:52:48] of them it's like one of the services we're providing much much the same as we're providing space at memorial hall so when it comes to a place we're providing space when it comes to the coaching model that we've been working on with four years across the commonwealth we are providing that service to the teachers of the lab school we're going to integrate it into our research which is the logical thing to do instead of saying we're setting up a separate coaching model just at a lab school because that's not what it was intended for to begin with it was intended to help all teachers across the commonwealth not just in four different schools that's the difference so to summarize so right you're providing the content and the right so when you talk about sustainability

[01:53:27] that's a key area of sustainability because that initiative runs separately from the lab school so So when you look at things to sustain professional growth, that would be a perfect example of something that is already in place, that will be in place if the lab school funding ran out.

[01:53:44] But the coaching that was just described, that is being provided by Rockingham staff, and you're at the superintendent at the district level, you are compensating those coaches for this time? How does that work?

[01:54:00] Just walk me through how does that, in a financial model, 'cause if that is a key component of the lab school, how are these individuals selected, compensated, kind of what's the extra pay for extra duty? And is that on your books then? And on other lab school books? - Yeah, that would be part of their normal duties to coach not just the folks in the lab schools.

[01:54:20] So we're not hiring instructional coaches just for the lab school, right? But to support our teachers who need additional support in the classrooms. And even these teachers who are working in the lab school will also serve students who aren't lab school students the other parts of the day, right?

[01:54:40] So in some ways it's just sort of our normal practice, but to get to your question, will there be support for these teachers in the lab school from coaching? Yeah, I think they'll get it from both JMU and from Rockingham as the need arises.

[01:54:57] And the teachers that we are working to put the lab school are our master teachers so part of everyone needs a coach so I'm not saying they don't they don't need coaching we all need coaching but they will in some ways themselves service coaches for pre-service teachers and practicum students who are coming in to observe and do some work so I see it sort of being almost a culture of this lab school is a

place where we're all learners that includes the teachers as much as the students and i'm i really for the record i

[01:55:33] want to make sure that we did not say that that coaching model is the priority of the lab school it is a tenant of professional development for teachers within the lab school and help it is not a core component of the lab school it is one of the several things that we're going to do to help support the lab school and the teachers but it's not the priority of the lab school i think that's very important to point out yeah so your question about the resources of jmu and the strengths of the teacher ed program in the application part of the the the lead portions of the professional

[01:56:12] learning for teachers is in collaboration with jmu faculty who are helping to develop that they're experts in methodology they're experts in teaching and learning which is why they will be engage in the lab school to help with professional learning on the front end throughout the year on the back end the additional supports that they get are based on that coaching framework that we mentioned like the VA and TSP that's helpful um and how many so as we look through the years for pre-service again I'm just kind of really trying to wrap my head around this

[01:56:46] um so for pre-service so you're putting out about what almost 400 teachers a year the number of jmu students that will be used for pre-service in year one is four year two is eight year three is eight is that correct right so and again so and that's it's special education you can add year four you can also put in remember because there's multiple subject areas so it's interdisciplinary so that's the ex that's expansion plus practicum students going back to what mr ortiz said today the purpose of a lab school was to look at research

[01:57:23] for best practices which in turn informs teacher education the best approaches to teach teachers how to teach so whether we have a lab school that has three teachers our lab school that has 300 you're looking for best practices then to go back because we have you know other smaller universities near us because we're actually in a consortium so we begin to start working with those saying here are these best practices one of the things that we brought up since day one it's essential that these lab schools connect as a network and not just a once in a year conference but actually

[01:58:01] as a network what are the best practices we're learning in different parts of the commonwealth so that we can learn from each other i already have my colleagues from old dominion from longwood university from norfolk state from virginia state from mary washington as part of a small collaborative that we're already doing now this is a very important piece of this so when you look at the numbers of the actual numbers of student teachers going in there it's not so much the numbers of student teachers going in there but the numbers of pre-service teachers that they'll be able to touch in several different ways to research through digital recordings just through

[01:58:35] a number of different uh here so i would i do think how many teachers go through for pre-service i would take issue i do think it matters and if you are producing almost 400 teachers a year but you're only providing four students with a pre-service opportunity i do believe that's not for me i'm gonna i respectfully disagree with you it won't be four because we have multiple subject areas multiple subject areas and just say if they take four different classes right just going through your uh you know for each per semester then there's going to be there's going to be more

[01:59:13] than four student teachers i'm just looking at the chart that you provided to us and the application says four people so that's what i have to go on so i'm going to go on to my next question about

this okay so what i'm hoping is i'm going to get penalized for putting through 300 teachers a year that doesn't make it you know i think that you are an amazing institution and one of the things i want to make sure that you're fully utilizing is also the opportunity to have more individuals that are going through your school of education involved in this lab school are benefiting from it and so that's why i'm asking the questions and and i mean i i sat on a school

[01:59:51] board for 10 years was deeply engaged in running a school and the staffing there and required and these charts for this staffing i'm struggling with them and i'm going to give you another example pair professionals we know for students that a pair of professionals are incredibly important right incredibly important and that's we're not even talking about related service personnel but pair professionals and you start off with year one with four pair of professionals for 100 students 50 students in year five you've got six 600 students and you still have only four pair of

[02:00:30] professionals but you've got 37 classrooms i i don't think that math works because when i think about what i see going on in a classroom unless these teachers i mean we've got 37 classrooms potentially and you have four paraprofessionals that means you have one paraprofessional per building their class load now went from one paraprofessional for 25 students to one paraprofessional for 125 students and if part of the core of this program and this is where i'm going to shift now to the learning side right for students i'm wondering how that instruction is going in

[02:01:09] the classroom for the student experience and so i'm wondering if maybe we can bridge this in the middle where i think you have so many amazing students at jmu who would probably be chomping at the bit to get classroom experience ability to support um that you've got this amazing network and so i'm why do you only have four pair of professionals or 600 kids so um i'm not sure if

[02:01:41] you remember when we were speaking with you in december a year ago we had really envisioned a different way of workforce about workforce redesign and i know that we are up against compliance with the soqs and staffing yeah and so um you know we have seen models across the country where you don't need a ratio of 1 to 25 or you don't need um somebody who you know one english

[02:02:16] teacher, one math teacher, one science teacher. But those are the compliance issues that we're up against. So in our minds, it's about a team of expertise. And so that team wraps around the support. So it's not that any one person in the lab school is doing this on their own. They're doing it as a team. So it's, you know, and I'm speaking from experience. I was a co-teacher in elementary school I had tons of children in my class but because I had one additional adult in the room we co-taught we felt like we could have 200 children in the class and we would do a good

[02:02:56] job because we were doing things differently and so that's kind of the way that we've approached this concept is redesigning what that looks like while also in the confines of compliance So if you look at the entire team of adults and the number of students, the way that we were thinking about this was that with all of the supports they're getting, that there would be ample adults in the rooms for the children.

[02:03:27] so if i'm in your lab school and i'm a kiddo um are there two teachers in that classroom is that what i just heard or is there a teacher and an industry expert or what does that team look like for a student and and i'm i look different on each day yeah right depending on what the activity is if you go if you go back to the other thing uh dynamic aviation you saw an airplane right there is no doubt in my mind that

we'll be bringing a group of students out there and that will become some of the classrooms they already do that type of work right now i think they're at east rock

[02:04:05] working with uh hundreds of your students at east rock right now and one of the things that they're really looking for they want to get these students out early and often and doing projects within within their facility within their campus so depending on what what it is and i think really what what needs to take place and listen to dr ortiz uh mr ortiz excuse me is this whole idea this is going to look different that that's the whole point of this lab school it's gonna if we're going to be innovative it's got to look different than what our what our mindset is that we believe what a typical school should look like we have the experts in place i believe that are near two

[02:04:43] if we have to make adjustments on that i believe that we'll have the data that doesn't drive us but we'll have the data that directs to what we need to do those numbers erupting because we've been asked to put numbers up there when i when i talk i go back to student teachers we can have practicum areas but we can say i can have hundreds of students but it's come by but is that the best thing for the students who are going to the lab school but number two is that the best way to teach teachers how to teach so the whole thing about this lab school is risk-taking in some ways because you know uh mr ortiz mentioned finland i just spent a week over there looking at early

[02:05:19] childhood uh development and care they do things differently and they become risk takers so it's getting out of the mindset that something looks a certain way and i think that's the key to the success of this the significance of what we're trying to do ma'am is that it's gonna look different it's gonna get a little messy at times but we have the expertise to be able to say you know what let's take a look at the data and how does it direct our next move we just we this is not a box that we can just put something in this is going to be a little squishy and when we feel comfortable we have expertise to do that and the stakeholder commitment in the community

[02:05:56] so wholeheartedly um so what i'm hearing is the the learning experience is intended to be different but the teaching experience right now is largely the same for rockingham's staff as it would be for lab schools because we're going to be using the same model so i'm so let's say you have a student with a disability that's in one of these classes um and i think this is really probably for for rockingham what services or supports are you pushing into that lab school or how are you doing

[02:06:32] that so that you were or an ell student or yeah help me understand that bridge because i don't see it in the staffing chart here right right and so um i want to make a comment though the learning is going to look differently in this space as well as the teaching okay so let's just go with that first year with the the freshman group there's going to be a world geography teacher in there there's going to be a health and pe teacher an english teacher and environmental science teacher but it's not going to be a traditional classroom where the world you know the world geography

[02:07:09] teacher has his 20 or 25 students and the english teacher has her group we're going to put these students together and there may be a point in time when the world geography teacher says i need to provide direct instruction to this whole entire group right all 50 students right for this point in time for maybe 30 minutes right we're not going to be governed by the bells and then they're back working on their projects and so it's it's going to look way differently than would be to say a traditional classroom and then students who would need resource right there's opportunities then

[02:07:42] um for if it's if it's a paraprofessional outside of the numbers here right if we have um paraprofessionals that serve you know that collaborate you know this right with our with our special education teachers uh who would come and provide support also in their schedule in the afternoon there's opportunities for these students to have resource if that's what they need and as you know their students want to continue them some students just need consult and we check in you know once a week or once a nine weeks are good and others need help sometimes with organization right i mean where they have to have someone every day sit down with them and say hey what's new next and that

[02:08:20] and that piece so um and going back to the paraprofessional we we kind of envision from Rockingham's perspective that being the fifth person on this team right so now we have flexibility maybe how we do groups how we work with folks maybe uh students you know need to go and be away from the group and we can send the paraprofessional with with that group of students or maybe a paraprofessional is going to watch a couple of kids work you know groups work as some teachers are providing some direct instruction so there's different ways to leverage how we use this person

[02:08:57] but as you alluded to earlier our prayer professionals do a tremendous job in our buildings they have they're highly skilled in many cases and have a lot to offer um does that answer your question it does um i have two more areas of focus and then that'll conclude my questions you're almost done um the next one is around uh student selection process so when i read your application on page 31 it refers to a selection committee and it who speaks to that the students would be selected representative to the demographics of the student body.

[02:09:34] Just talk with me a little bit about this because when I read through your application, the language, I'll just, it's not always consistent. Sometimes it's talking about a lottery. Sometimes it's talking about selection. Harmonize what I'm seeing on the paper and give me as succinct an answer of how are you going to select these students?

[02:09:58] - So the answer is both. So the lottery selection is one way to ensure that students aren't being selected based on preference or other factors and also within compliance with the law. The selection committee, the recruitment and selection committee is a way to affirm and confirm the selection process.

[02:10:21] So it includes the people who are engaged in this work a daily basis who understand recruitment and selection can assure that what we're doing is fair, it's equitable, and it's based on this random lottery selection.

[02:10:37] So this group, so it's not just one person who is spinning the wheel or drawing a stick to determine who gets into the lab school, it's a group of people who can affirm that process. And the initial figure of the lab school was that it would be a leaked school, and that's exact opposite of what which that where it goes back to middle school middle school is known as the best last chance for some kids and we see that this is like an extension of that that will really benefit i don't know if you want to respond on that at all well as as we were thinking about

[02:11:12] how do we build a lab school where all students could participate we didn't include math in this right because our students some of them take algebra one in the middle school and so they come to the high school as freshmen they're taking geometry so if we tried to put either algebra or geometry alone in this lab setting we would then exclude a group of students one way or the other we didn't want to do that so that's why we were very thoughtful in saying okay what are the courses that all of our freshmen take

regardless of their track and it is world geography environmental studies our environmental science english 9 health and pe and so that's why we picked that

[02:11:52] and we were even thoughtful like our cte director and our fine arts supervisor they were fussing at me a little bit saying well we want to be we want to be included in the lab school and i'm like well as soon as we say cte courses then we've excluded kids who maybe aren't going to take agriculture or who aren't going to take band right so we wanted to we wanted to target a wide of cast that net as wide as we possibly could to give kids another chance at this freshman year and then go from there okay that makes sense it does um last question um in the section on financial

[02:12:26] and operations the the staff uh flagged the kind of lack of permanency of the facility plan i think i've i've heard a bit more about that today in a satisfactory way however i would like to know more about your sustainability plan for funding um if you could kind of vary again how much are you requesting through this lab school application i it looks like in year six you're going to need roughly 3.8 million dollars where's that net going to come from and i i know you have

[02:13:03] an amazing advancement office i know i think i get mailers from them um but i need more than that because otherwise every university that steps before this lab committee could say hey i have office of advancement i know you do i need a plan yeah so um and you know in the application when when we talked about sustainability we talked about how the tuition support would be very much like rockingham already pays for tuition for students to go to the regional governor school um because this is 50 of their day 50 of the funding in rockingham would automatically help

[02:13:41] sustain the work with or without advancement with or without grants um advancement grants can help offset that cost um or enhance it exactly and so um that's what we had planned on with sustainability is that it would be a tuition cost that would be paid for by rockingham county at the level to which rockingham county could afford um and then supplemented with additional and the key piece from day one that we started this and that's why this maybe has put us on this pathway we

[02:14:16] believe principle principle that we do not want this lab school to take money away from local school division the model that we have set up shows that money goes right back into rockingham in that lab school experience will be maintained that's the key especially for some of the longitudinal studies, because we believe that's the key piece, that if James Madison University began to take ADM from Rockingham County, we wouldn't be having a partner sitting here right

[02:14:51] now. So it's a key piece that we're together. So semantics here, just to make sure I'm right, Rockingham is going to pay for these slots at the lab school, and in turn, that's the tuition you're charging so six thousand dollars ahead for 600 students is 3.6 million dollars a year that's your plan for sustainability and you're based there you're charging back like that's how i would refer to it back in my k-12 days as you're doing a charge back you're paying for the slot

[02:15:26] you're buying the slot you're getting the service but for the interest of transparencies on the books you're showing that as kind of like a separate business account is that how i should understand this and it's your your community understands that you're doing a passback of 3.6 million dollars a year for this 600 students okay and they're committed to sustain that yeah i believe so yes okay okay all right thank you for your patience with all my questions i i really i think that

[02:16:03] times it's hard to tell from the paper right the paper doesn't always give us robust a picture and for example what we just talked about there in terms of sustainability like that i just don't see that in the paper so we'll talk about that some more and we'll think on our side too how maybe we can further refine the application one of the things that you all have been so gracious about and i've talked about in the committee here is as we have our first applicants come through the process we're learning right along with you and we're learning sometimes how to improve our application so that we can elicit this information in a more efficient way and today was not as

[02:16:42] efficient but you're giving me an insight into how we're going to improve that application further so thank you thank you so much for your time i appreciate it thank you with that i'm going to just take a 10-minute recess um for the benefit of the committee members and the staff and then we

[02:16:55] will reconvene at 15 past the hour um before we were just uh having a fantastic conversation with

[02:29:21] JMU about their incredibly exciting application and their plans what we're going to what I'm without if there's no objection from the committee members what I would propose at this time is that we refer JMU back for some additional support and coaching from staff to further refine the application we've got some really great information today in this conversation and let's make sure that all of that really good content like what they talked about for their pd plan first for staff phenomenal let's make sure that that's included in the application

[02:30:00] one of the things that has been really important is that when we put an application out for public comment that it is in its fullest complete version and so let's make sure that the application is fully complete of all the wonderful plans that jmu has in place and then we can take this matter back up at our first meeting in september which will be september 6th i believe wednesday because that monday is a holiday okay there's no objection that'll be the plan on that item and then from

[02:30:33] this we will move now to item d update on planning grant expenditures and mr chapman is being subbed in for mr railer dr raley on short notice so we're going to go easy on him today but he's going to give us a quick update on the planning grant expenditures uh from the lab school grants mr chapman absolutely thank you miss briska members of the committee um you'll you'll notice that as item d uh the the department has provided a we think is a very robust and full update on on

[02:31:09] what is happening with the standing committees um we don't have that on screen and so sorry if you are you are looking there um but beginning with that five million dollar balance we essentially show an order of what has happened with uh with each planning grant um each award winner and how that has uh has affected the the running balance in the fund um you'll notice that the the total balance that we have remaining is uh it was one thousand six hundred five one million six hundred five thousand five hundred seventy five dollars and we have one planning grant expenditure that's that's currently in the pipeline that we expect to move soon or at least a decision to be made

[02:31:47] soon. But so all of that said, we still have a fairly robust 1.5 of safely even accounting for the potential expenditure that might be pending. About 1.5 million still left in that balance. That's incredibly helpful information. If you don't mind, since you're there, why don't we bundle this and have you begin also providing us an update on the item e which is the college partnership lab school application pipeline this was a fantastic document so thank you sure yeah absolutely yeah you'll you'll notice that actually these these two documents can be

[02:32:26] read in tandem um because in addition to the you know the full contact information everything we have for the standing committee as part of the item e uh spreadsheet um we also have in in that timeline the the award date and so we would expect that about one year past award date we would start having you know the applications come in that's on the grant of course you you're aware as a committee that based on the timelines in some sense how that things work the perfect one year is is a maybe a little bit unlikely and so with the spreadsheet we'll be able to continue updating this item we have you know the the planning grant applicants that we've been able to confirm with

[02:33:01] what the expected timelines are for receiving those applications. And so you'll notice that two of those planning grant award winners, Mountain Gateway Community College and Germanic Community College, are both in the second week of July or in July, which of course is we are right at the end of July. And the good news is we do in fact have those applications in hand. So that is a great part of the work that's been done on this timeline is we can actually confirm that those timelines are being hit. And there are plans internally for the subject matter expert group to convene later this week to discuss those two applications. So we hope that those will be

[02:33:39] coming to you at a standing committee meeting in the future. Excellent. We're looking forward to that. Mr. Chapman, if you would, in the future, will it be Dr. Armstrong that is presenting these items or will it continue to be Dr. Rayleigh? Well, I sure hope that we are all going to get to benefit from, from Dr. Armstrong as soon as possible. My understanding as of right now is that, yeah, we're going to be seeing a lot more work with Dr. Armstrong, but I certainly hope that that won't, won't exclude Dr. Raley from participating. We'll keep him linked into the

[02:34:13] work for sure. Well, Dr. Armstrong in the future, I think this item E in particular, as well as item D, this has been invaluable information for the committee for us to be able to forecast work. So if we could make these standing items and update us each month, I know that, you know, when the lab school might actually submit really is, it's a forecast.

[02:34:36] And much like the weather, we will not hold you responsible if that forecast adjusts or change. But I do think it's going to be really helpful for us to start planning work and when and which months we may need to have some additional bandwidth added for the time.

[02:34:53] Okay. So with that, thank you, Mr. Chapman. made it through unscathed um with that we're going to move to discussion of current items i have a couple quick items for the lab committee members and then i want to open it up for any other items from other committee members all right the first is uh refinement of the application at our last committee meeting we made some fantastic adjustments thanks to the the staff work uh to the application having talked with vdoe staff some of the information that was received

[02:35:25] today i'm going to direct staff to further work on refining the application and that when we come back in september we will see again another iteration of a more refined application and even in the wonderful dialogue we had with gmu today you can see that there are elements that we will need information on that the application as it's written right now just isn't prompting so just know that that area is coming i would suspect you know we'll need to see some refinements around the area of sustainability and budgeting governance ferpa if there's input from committee

[02:36:05] members on from what we heard from mr ramos today of what details of quality uh lab school if there's further changes we want to make in the area of teaching and learning to kind of elicit that type of

information think about that ponder it and certainly if you have any input you know let's get that into staff but i i do feel like we're we're honing in on it so that's number one um number two you've already heard me talk about our next meeting is going to be wednesday september 6th that'll be a departure from our normal monday meeting um because of the labor day holiday

[02:36:40] and i just want to flag that for everyone the third is at the next meeting if staff could provide us in the september meeting also an update on how things are going with kind of developing a professional learning community there's two parts to this part number one is for existing lab grantees that are in the planning stage and number two is going to be for the lab schools themselves again i think as we heard from mr ramos today a key tenant of a lab school is research and applying

[02:37:16] then using that information to improve teaching and learning and i think it would be valuable to get from staff a plan on how we would intentionally share information and i'll call it learnings from the lab schools with other non-lab schools that's something that dr moran raised and there's two parts to this there's the k-12 part but not to be missed is the higher ed how are we preparing

[02:37:50] teachers and i think that may be you know getting information into chev or abtel but i want to be intentional about that and and if we could get a plan from staff and and you know in your first 30 days or so but just maybe an outline to start kind of marinating on and thinking how do we do this with intention versus organically we do a really good job sometimes of doing that you know we do it organically but how do we get serious about that since that's going to be such a good benefit these lab schools and we really heard that um soundly from from mr ramos so those were kind of the three

[02:38:27] things i just want to share with the committee members and the benefit of the public they're kind of on my mind that we're thinking about next okay um with that uh discussion of other current issues from members i have none just a it is an agenda i'm just how excited i mean we just saw we got some stuff coming down the pike it's really exciting um i'm excited about jmu's application and where we're going to get it's a uh i think it's a terrific concept i like the way they're working um you know across the district and multi-sites and it's like the momentum here is is is good um and the staff work has been great making sure that we're diligent we're building

[02:39:05] things that are that are going to last but the momentum here is really exciting okay um at this time we have no public comment on non-agenda items so hearing no further business before the committee we stand adjourned thank you and we'll see you back in september

